

Analysis of Sales Trends and Inventory Management in a Women's Ethnic Wear Business

A Final report for the BDM capstone Project

Submitted by

Name:Naman Gupta

Roll number:23F2002076 .



IITM Online BS Degree Program,
Indian Institute of Technology, Madras, Chennai
Tamil Nadu, India, 600036

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1 Executive Summary

Tulsi is a women's ethnic wear retail store located in the New Market area of Bhopal, serving a B2C customer base with products such as kurti sets, suits, and unstitched fabrics. Although the store has a stable presence, it faces operational challenges such as seasonal fluctuations in demand and increasing competition from online platforms like Myntra and Ajio. Earlier, most decisions related to purchasing and staffing were based on the owner's experience, which led to gaps in operations. One clear example was the excess purchase mismatch of ₹1.52L observed in February 2026, where stock levels remained high even after demand dropped following the wedding season.

The analysis was based on primary transaction data collected between December 2025 and February 2026 from sales records and purchase bills. To make the study more data-driven, multiple analytical methods were applied. ABC and Pareto analysis were used to identify high-value inventory categories, while EOQ, Safety Stock, and Reorder Point were used to improve purchasing decisions. In addition, seasonal workload patterns were studied using time-slot data, and price benchmarking was done to compare the store's pricing with online platforms.

The results show that kurti sets are the most important inventory category, contributing 50.3% of total investment and requiring close monitoring. The excess stock observed in February highlights the need for better alignment between purchasing and actual demand. EOQ calculations indicate an optimal order size of 111 units for this category, with reordering required when stock reaches the reorder point of 62 units. Workload analysis also shows that customer activity is highest during afternoon and evening hours (3 PM – 7 PM), while morning hours remain relatively underutilized.

Based on these findings, it is recommended that the store adopt a more structured purchasing approach using EOQ and reorder-based planning. Instead of following fixed buying patterns, purchases should be adjusted based on demand trends to protect Gross Profit. From an operational perspective, staff responsibilities should be aligned with customer flow, with more focus on customer service during peak hours and backend tasks shifted to low-traffic periods. These changes can help reduce excess inventory, improve cash flow, and make daily operations more efficient.

2 Detailed Explanation of Analysis Process/Method

2.1 Data Collection

The analysis uses a combination of primary and secondary data sources to address the key operational and market-related problems of the business.

1. Transaction Data (Primary Data)

Primary data was collected from Tulsi store's manual sales diaries and purchase bills. The data covers a three-month period from December 2025 to February 2026. It includes key variables such as product category, quantity, purchase price, selling price, and estimated sales value. This dataset forms the basis for inventory analysis, including ABC and Pareto classification, as well as demand estimation and EOQ calculations.

2. Competition Data (Secondary Data)

To analyse competition from online platforms, pricing data was collected from major e-commerce websites, namely Myntra, Ajio, and Amazon. Since these platforms have a large number of listings, a bestseller filtering approach was used to select the top-selling products in the kurti set category. The dataset includes product name, price, and platform source. This allows a realistic comparison between Tulsi's pricing and the price range offered by online competitors.

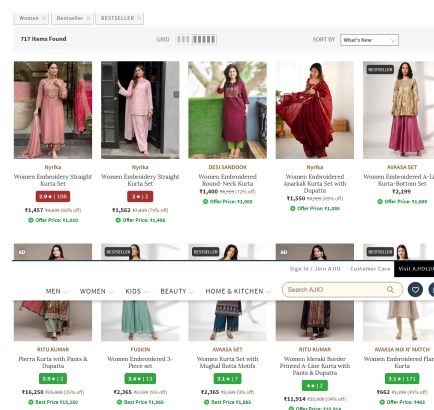


Figure 2.1: Data collection using bestseller filter from Myntra

3. Work Distribution Data (Primary Observation)

Work distribution data was collected through in-store observation and discussions with the shop owner. Customer flow was divided into different time slots and classified into three levels: low, moderate, and high. Separate patterns were identified for winter and summer seasons to capture variations in customer behaviour due to seasonal and festive factors.

Justification of Data Collection Approach

The use of both primary and secondary data ensures a comprehensive analysis of all problem areas. Primary data provides accurate insights into the store's internal operations and financial gaps, while filtered competitor data reflects real market conditions. Observational data further helps in understanding staff workload and operational efficiency.

2.2 Data Cleaning and Preprocessing

Before performing the analysis, all collected datasets were cleaned, transformed, and converted into structured formats. Since the data was obtained from manual records and online sources, it contained inconsistencies in formatting, units, and representation. Additionally, several analytical variables required for further analysis were not directly available and were derived during preprocessing.

2.2.1 Cleaning and Transformation of Transaction Data

The raw transaction dataset contained inconsistencies in monetary values and lacked certain derived variables required for analysis.

Data Cleaning Steps

- Currency symbols (₹) and commas were removed
- All price-related columns were converted into numeric format
- Column names were standardized for consistency
- Duplicate or inconsistent entries were checked and corrected

These steps ensured that the dataset became consistent and ready for further analysis.

	SNO	MONTH	ARTICLE	CATEGORY	QUANTITY	PURCHASE_PRICE	TOTAL_PURCHASE	SELLING_PRICE	ESTIMATED_SALES
1	1	202	KAF20426	KURTI SET	8	1444	11552	2166	17328
2	2	202	NI20256	KURTI SET	10	1045	10450	1568	15680
3	3	202	TAPS17603	KURTI SET	8	1832	14656	2748	21984
4	4	202	RRF7860	KURTI SET	18	1045	18810	1568	28224
5	5	202	CB612	KURTI SET	5	1045	5225	1568	7840
6	6	202	CB642	KURTI SET	10	1045	10450	1568	15680
7	7	202	RRF7860	KURTI SET	18	1045	18810	1568	28224
8	8	202	RRF7814	KURTI SET	12	1045	12540	1568	18816
9	9	202	GRC20571	KURTI SET	15	1045	15675	1568	23520
10	10	202	KAF20426	KURTI SET	8	1444	11552	2166	17328

Table 2.1: Purchase Dataset with Derived Values

Explanation: Table 2.1 shows the purchase dataset after cleaning and formatting. The dataset contains consistent entries and verified values for all variables.

Derivation of Key Variables

Certain variables required for analysis were not directly available and were derived as follows:

(a) Total Purchase Value

$$\text{Total Purchase} = \text{Quantity} \times \text{Purchase Price}$$

(b) Estimated Selling Price

Based on the store owner's statement of a 50% profit margin, the selling price was estimated:

$$\text{Estimated Selling Price} = 1.5 \times \text{Purchase Price}$$

(c) Estimated Sales Value

$$\text{Estimated Sales Value} = \text{Quantity} \times \text{Estimated Selling Price}$$

Justification of Derived Variables

The variables derived during the preprocessing phase are the functional foundation for solving Tulsi's core operational problems:

- **Financial Prioritization (ABC/Pareto Analysis):** Deriving total purchase values per transaction is essential to categorize inventory by its financial weight. This justifies the identification of "Class A" items (Kurti Sets), which hold 50.3% of the store's capital, allowing for prioritized management.
- **Inventory Optimization (EOQ & ROP):** Annualized demand and standardized unit costs serve as the primary inputs for the Economic Order Quantity (EOQ) and Reorder Point (ROP) models. These derived metrics are specifically designed to eliminate the ₹1.52L excess purchase gap identified in February by replacing intuition with scientific procurement triggers.
- **Operational Alignment (Intensity Scale):** Converting qualitative customer flow observations into a numerical transaction-per-hour scale is necessary for generating Workload Heatmaps. This justifies the strategic shift of non-essential backend tasks to morning hours to ensure maximum sales support during peak afternoon traffic.

2.2.2 Structuring of Work Distribution Data

The work distribution dataset was initially collected in a qualitative form through direct observation and discussion with the store owner. To make this data suitable for analysis, it was systematically converted into a structured and quantifiable format.

Customer flow across the day was divided into fixed time slots, and each time slot was classified based on the level of activity observed. To enable comparison and graphical representation, qualitative categories were encoded into numerical values.

SEASON	TIME SLOT	CUSTOMER FLOW	LEVEL
Winter	11 AM – 1 PM	Low (Few customers)	1
Winter	1 PM – 3 PM	Moderate (Steady flow)	2
Winter	3 PM – 5 PM	Peak (High crowd)	3
Winter	5 PM – 7 PM	Peak (High crowd)	3
Winter	7 PM – 9 PM	Moderate (Steady flow)	2
Summer	11 AM – 1 PM	Low (Few customers)	1
Summer	1 PM – 3 PM	Low (Few customers)	1
Summer	3 PM – 5 PM	Moderate (Steady flow)	2
Summer	5 PM – 7 PM	Moderate (Steady flow)	2
Summer	7 PM – 9 PM	Peak (High crowd)	3

Table 2.2: Final Structured and Encoded Dataset

Processing Logic

- Time slots were standardized to ensure consistency across seasons
- Customer flow was categorized into three levels: Low, Moderate, and Peak
- Each category was assigned a numerical value (1, 2, 3) to enable analysis

Justification

This approach ensures that staffing and operational decisions are based on data rather than intuition. Converting qualitative observations into a structured numerical dataset allows for:

- Comparison of workload across different time periods
- Identification of peak hours
- Visualization using charts such as line graphs and heatmaps

2.2.3 Structuring of Competition Data

The competition dataset was collected from online platforms including Myntra, Ajio, and Amazon. Since the raw data consisted of multiple product listings with varying price ranges, it was necessary to filter and standardize the data for meaningful comparison.

To ensure relevance, a bestseller filtering approach was applied, where only top-selling products in the kurti set category were selected. This ensures that the analysis reflects actual customer demand rather than random product listings.

The collected data was then cleaned and converted into a structured format. Prices were standardized by removing currency symbols and converting them into numeric values. To enable comparison across platforms, prices were further categorized into defined price bands.

Price Range	Price Band
Below ₹700	Low
₹700 – ₹1200	Medium
Above ₹1200	High

The selected price ranges reflect the natural clustering of competitor prices, enabling clear differentiation between budget, mid-range, and premium segments.

SOURCE	PRICE (₹)	PRICE BAND
Myntra	1439	High
Myntra	908	Medium
Myntra	1609	High
Myntra	1518	High
Myntra	1720	High
Myntra	949	Medium
Myntra	640	Low
Myntra	1817	High
Myntra	1407	High
Myntra	1374	High
Ajio	1457	High
Ajio	1562	High

Table 2.3: Final Structured and Classified Dataset

Analytical Justification

This structured approach enables a consistent and meaningful comparison across platforms. By grouping prices into standardized bands, it becomes easier to identify:

- the store's relative positioning within the market
- the concentration of products across different price segments
- the extent of competitive pressure in low, medium, and high price ranges

Focusing on bestseller products ensures that the analysis reflects actual customer preferences rather than random listings, making the insights more reliable for decision-making.

2.2.4 Importance of Data Cleaning

Data cleaning and preprocessing play a critical role in ensuring the accuracy and reliability of the analysis. Since the raw data was collected from manual records and online sources, it contained inconsistencies in format, units, and representation.

By converting the data into structured and standardized formats, errors in calculations were minimized and consistency across datasets was ensured. The derivation of variables such as total purchase value and estimated selling price further enabled meaningful analysis of inventory and revenue.

2.3 Analytical Methods

Based on the cleaned and structured datasets, analytical methods were applied to address the identified operational problems. Each method was selected to provide a data-driven solution to specific business challenges faced by the store.

2.3.1 Methods for Problem Statement 1: Inventory Management

The store faced issues related to excess inventory, demand mismatch, and inefficient purchasing decisions. To address this, the following methods were applied:

(a) ABC Analysis: ABC analysis was applied to classify inventory categories based on their contribution to total investment using purchase data from December 2025 to February 2026. The analysis was performed on approximately 153 unique products (SKUs) across all categories.

$$\text{Category Investment} = \sum (\text{Quantity} \times \text{Purchase Price})$$

$$\text{Percentage Contribution} = (\text{Category Investment} / \text{Total Investment}) \times 100$$

$$\text{Cumulative Percentage} = \sum \text{Percentage Contribution}$$

Classification Rule:

Class	Contribution
A	Top 70%
B	Next 20%
C	Remaining 10%

This method helps prioritize high-investment categories (Class A), ensuring better control over capital-intensive items and reducing the risk of overstocking.

(b) Pareto Analysis

Pareto analysis was applied to visualize the distribution of total investment across inventory categories using the same dataset as the ABC analysis. Categories were arranged in descending order of total purchase value, and cumulative percentage contribution was plotted to identify concentration of investment.

The analysis shows that a small number of categories contribute to a large portion of total investment, consistent with the Pareto principle (80/20 rule). Specifically, the first two categories account for approximately 80% of the total investment, with Kurti Sets alone contributing the highest share.

This pattern highlights a strong concentration of capital in limited categories, indicating that inventory risk and financial exposure are not evenly distributed. As a result, management attention must be focused on these high-impact categories.

The Pareto analysis complements ABC classification by providing a visual representation of investment concentration, forming the basis for prioritizing inventory control and applying EOQ and ROP models to the most critical categories.

(c) Economic Order Quantity (EOQ)

The Economic Order Quantity (EOQ) model was used to determine the optimal order quantity that minimizes the total inventory cost, which includes ordering and holding costs.

$$EOQ = \sqrt{\frac{2DS}{H}}$$

where D is annual demand, S is ordering cost per order, and H is holding cost per unit per year.

Demand (D) was calculated for each product individually using purchase quantity data obtained from store records for the period December 2025 to February 2026:

$$D_{3\text{-month}} = \sum \text{Quantity Purchased (per product)}$$

Since the EOQ model requires annual demand, the value was converted as follows:

$$D = D_{3\text{-month}} \times 4$$

The ordering cost (S) was taken as ₹500 per order, as provided by the store owner. This includes transportation and handling costs associated with procurement.

The holding cost (H) was calculated as 15% of the purchase price, where 15% represents the annual inventory carrying rate. This rate accounts for storage costs, capital tie-up, and the risk of unsold inventory:

$$H = 0.15 \times \text{Purchase Price}$$

The annualization of demand was necessary because the dataset covers a three-month period, while holding cost is defined on an annual basis. Multiplying demand by 4 ensures consistency between all variables used in the EOQ model.

(d) Safety Stock

Safety stock was calculated to account for demand variability during lead time.

$$SS = Z \times \sigma_d \times \sqrt{LT}$$

Variable Definition and Source

- $Z = 1.65 \rightarrow$ corresponds to 95% service level . A 95% service level was selected to balance the cost of holding additional inventory against the store owner's priority of avoiding stockouts during high-demand periods such as the wedding season.
- σ_d = standard deviation of demand (calculated from data)
- LT = Lead Time

Lead Time Justification

$$LT = 7 \text{ days}$$

This value was obtained from the store owner, representing the average time taken for inventory to be delivered from suppliers. Safety stock ensures that demand fluctuations and supplier delays do not lead to stockouts, especially during high-demand periods such as the wedding season.

(e) Reorder Point (ROP)

ROP determines the inventory level at which a new order should be placed.

$$ROP = (d \times LT) + SS$$

- $d = D / 365$ (daily demand)
- $LT = 7$ days
- $SS =$ safety stock

ROP provides a practical decision rule for the store owner, ensuring that inventory is replenished at the right time without overstocking or stockouts.

2.3.2 Methods for Problem Statement 2: Competition Analysis

Price Benchmarking

To analyze competition from online platforms, price benchmarking was conducted using product data collected from leading e-commerce platforms: Myntra, Ajio, and Amazon. Given that these platforms contain a vast number of listings, a bestseller filtering approach was applied to select top-performing products specifically within the kurti set category. This ensures that the comparison reflects actual customer demand and market trends rather than random or low-performing product listings.

The collected price data was standardized and converted into a numeric format to ensure analytical consistency. To enable a meaningful comparison across diverse platforms, prices were grouped into three defined segments or "Price Bands":

- Low: Price $< ₹700$
- Medium: $₹700 \leq \text{Price} \leq ₹1200$
- High: Price $> ₹1200$

These thresholds were determined based on the observed distribution of competitor prices, ensuring a balanced segmentation across budget, mid-range, and premium categories.

By classifying products into these standardized price bands, the study can effectively compare how different platforms position their offerings. This classification helps identify whether Tulsi's current pricing aligns with low-cost, mid-range, or premium market segments.

The focus on bestseller products strengthens the analysis by reflecting actual consumer preferences and high-velocity market demand. Consequently, this benchmarking provides a realistic view of the competitive pricing pressure the store faces from digital giants.

This method is instrumental in:

- **Identifying Pricing Gaps:** Recognizing where Tulsi may be over-priced or where there is an opportunity to capture a specific segment.
- **Strategic Decision Support:** Informing decisions regarding price adjustments, seasonal discounts, or the introduction of bundled offers to remain competitive.

2.3.3 Methods for Problem Statement 3: Work Distribution

Workload Analysis

Workload analysis was performed using the customer flow data collected for different time slots across winter and summer seasons. The day was divided into fixed time intervals, and each slot was assigned a workload level based on observed customer activity.

Based on store observation, the classification was defined as:

- Low: minimal customer presence
- Moderate: steady but manageable flow
- Peak: high customer density requiring maximum staff attention

Each time slot was classified into low, moderate, and peak based on observed customer flow and encoded as 1, 2, and 3, respectively, to enable comparison and analysis.

The same time slots were used for both seasons to ensure consistency. This structured dataset was then used to compare workload patterns across different time periods and identify peak operational hours.

3. Results and Findings

This section presents the findings from the datasets collected regarding Tulsi's inventory, market competition, and staff workload. Through systematic data visualization and interpretation, these results reveal critical operational insights and serve as the foundation for the strategic recommendations discussed later in this report.

3.1 Problem Statement 1: Inventory Management

The inventory analysis was conducted to identify high-investment product categories, evaluate the concentration of working capital across inventory, and determine whether scientific inventory control methods are required to reduce excess stock accumulation.

3.1.1 ABC–Pareto Classification Results

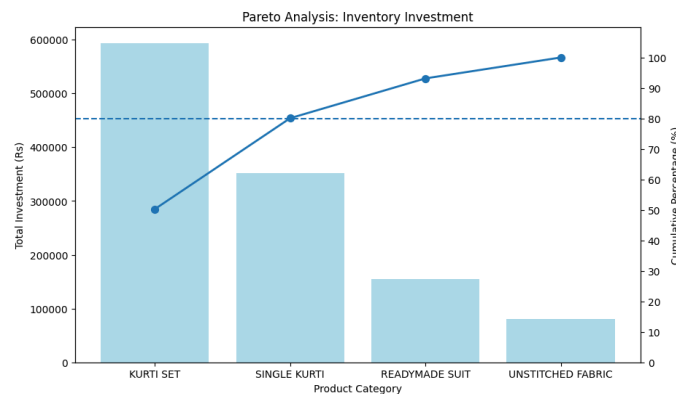


Figure 3.1: Pareto Analysis of Inventory Investment

Key Findings

- Kurti Sets contribute approximately **50.3%** of the total inventory investment.
- The first two categories together account for nearly **80%** of total investment.
- Investment concentration is highly uneven across inventory categories.
- Kurti Sets represent the store's most financially critical inventory segment.

Interpretation and Business Insight : The Pareto distribution confirms that Tulsi's inventory investment is concentrated within a limited number of product categories. Although the store deals in multiple product types, a major portion of working capital remains tied primarily to Kurti Sets and Single Kurtis.

This concentration creates strong financial dependency on a few categories. As a result, inefficient procurement decisions within these segments can directly affect stock turnover, liquidity, and profitability.

The ABC classification further highlights that Kurti Sets fall under **Class A inventory** because of their dominant contribution to total investment. Since Class A products consume

the majority of capital, they require stricter monitoring, controlled procurement cycles, and more frequent inventory review compared to lower-value categories.

These findings establish the need for scientific inventory optimization methods specifically targeted toward high-investment inventory instead of applying identical procurement practices across all product categories.

3.1.2 Inventory Optimization Findings (EOQ, Safety Stock, and ROP)

	CATEGORY	ANNUAL_DEMAND	EOQ	SAFETY_STOCK	ROP
0	KURTI SET	2080	110.54	21.57	62.02
1	READYMADE SUIT	456	46.58	18.45	27.32
2	SINGLE KURTI	1840	116.20	49.45	85.22
3	UNSTITCHED FABRIC	312	44.94	3.98	10.04

Figure 3.2: Inventory Optimization Results

Key Findings

- The EOQ for Kurti Sets was calculated as **111 units**.
- Safety Stock was estimated at **22 units**.
- The Reorder Point (ROP) was identified at **62 units**.
- A procurement mismatch of approximately **₹1.52L** was observed during February 2026.

Interpretation and Business Insight : The optimization results demonstrate that Tulsi currently lacks a structured inventory replenishment mechanism. Procurement decisions were largely based on fixed purchasing habits and owner intuition rather than demand-driven inventory planning.

This issue became highly visible in February 2026, where purchasing activity continued despite a sharp post-wedding decline in customer demand. Consequently, approximately ₹1.52L of working capital became tied up in excess inventory.

The EOQ model shows that smaller and scientifically calculated procurement cycles are operationally more efficient than large bulk purchases. Ordering approximately 111 units at

optimized intervals minimizes the combined effect of ordering cost and annual inventory carrying cost.

Similarly, the Safety Stock value of 22 units acts as a protective buffer against supplier delays and sudden demand fluctuations during wedding and festive periods. The Reorder Point of 62 units further provides a practical procurement trigger that identifies when inventory replenishment should begin. These findings confirm that implementing EOQ and ROP-based procurement can significantly improve inventory turnover, reduce stagnant stock accumulation, and protect cash flow from unnecessary capital blockage.

3.2 Problem Statement 2: Competitive Positioning

Competition analysis was conducted to evaluate Tulsi's pricing relative to major online platforms including Myntra, Ajio, and Amazon. Bestseller product data collected from these platforms was used to identify market positioning and pricing pressure across different segments.

3.2.1 Price Band Distribution Analysis

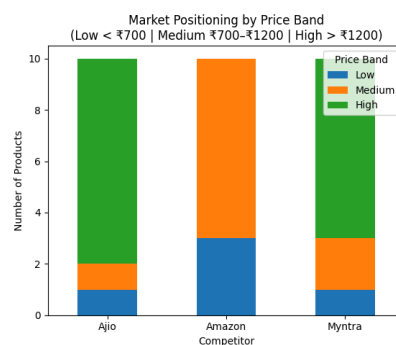


Figure 3.3: Competitor Price Band Distribution

Key Findings

- More than half of Amazon products fall within low and medium price ranges.
- Myntra and Ajio show stronger representation within medium and premium segments.
- Tulsi's pricing falls primarily within the medium and upper-medium category.
- Premium online listings overlap directly with Tulsi's pricing range.

Interpretation and Business Insight : The price band distribution indicates that Tulsi competes more directly with premium online listings rather than low-cost mass-market products. While Amazon demonstrates aggressive pricing within budget-oriented segments, Myntra and Ajio contain several products positioned within higher-value ethnic wear categories similar to Tulsi’s offerings.

This overlap creates pricing pressure during online discount periods, where branded products temporarily enter lower price bands and become more attractive to customers.

At the same time, the analysis suggests that Tulsi maintains competitive positioning within the medium-price segment, particularly for customers who prefer immediate availability, personalized assistance, and physical product verification before purchase.

These findings highlight the importance of flexible seasonal pricing, bundled offers, and customer experience differentiation as strategic tools for maintaining competitiveness against online platforms.

3.2.2 Competitive Benchmarking Insights

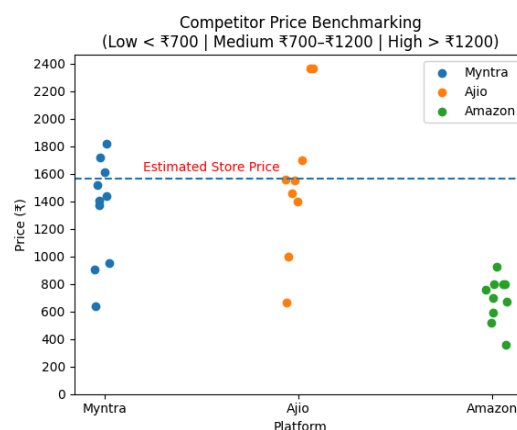


Figure 3.4: Platform-wise Price Benchmarking

Key Findings

- Significant price variation exists across online platforms.
- Myntra and Ajio contain multiple premium-priced listings.
- Amazon demonstrates stronger concentration in lower-price ranges.

- Tulsi's pricing remains comparatively aligned with premium and upper-mid categories.

Interpretation and Business Insight : The benchmarking visualization highlights that customer purchasing decisions are increasingly influenced by platform-based price comparisons. Consequently, maintaining competitiveness solely through pricing may not be sustainable for a local retail business.

Instead, Tulsi's competitive advantage must focus on areas where online platforms are relatively weaker, including personalized customer interaction, trust-based relationships, immediate product availability, and customized shopping assistance.

The analysis therefore suggests that combining moderate pricing flexibility with enhanced customer service can help Tulsi sustain its competitive position against large digital platforms.

3.3 Problem Statement 3: Operational Efficiency and Workload Distribution

Workload analysis was conducted to evaluate customer flow intensity across different time slots and identify operational inefficiencies related to staff utilization and task allocation.

3.3.1 Seasonal Workload Heatmap Analysis

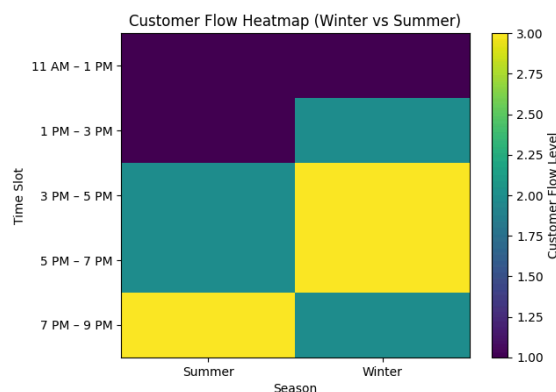


Figure 3.5: Seasonal Workload Heatmap

Key Findings

- Winter workload intensity peaks between **3 PM and 7 PM**.

- Summer customer flow shifts toward evening hours between **6 PM and 9 PM**.
- Peak intensity reaches **Level 3 workload periods** during afternoon and evening hours.
- Morning periods consistently show lower customer activity.
- Workload distribution remains uneven throughout the day.

Interpretation and Business Insight : The heatmap visualization demonstrates that customer activity is highly concentrated within specific afternoon and evening periods. During winter, festive shopping and wedding-related purchases significantly increase customer flow during late afternoon hours.

In summer, customer movement shifts toward evening periods due to weather-related behavioral changes. Despite seasonal differences, both datasets consistently indicate underutilization during morning hours. This uneven workload distribution creates operational pressure during peak periods while leaving certain staff hours inefficiently utilized.

The findings therefore support the need for workload-based staff planning, where customer-facing support is strengthened during high-intensity periods and backend operational activities such as inventory arrangement, stock verification, and product tagging are shifted toward low-traffic morning slots.

3.3.2 Staff Utilization Findings

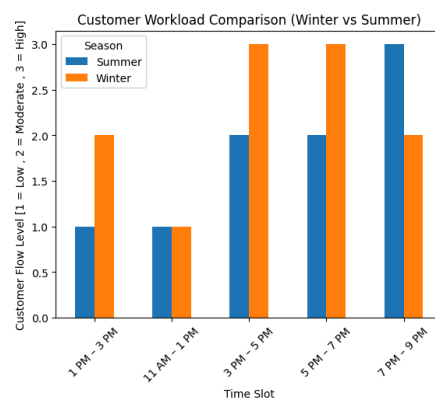


Figure 3.6: Time Slot-wise Workload Comparison

Key Findings

- Customer flow varies significantly across different time periods.
- Peak periods require maximum customer-handling capacity.
- Morning slots remain comparatively underutilised, and operational workload is highly time-dependent.

Interpretation and Business Insight : The workload comparison shows that customer intensity varies significantly throughout the day, with peak periods increasing pressure on billing, customer assistance, and product handling activities. In contrast, lower morning customer flow creates opportunities for backend operational tasks and better staff redistribution.

The findings suggest that aligning staff responsibilities with customer flow intensity can improve operational efficiency, reduce customer waiting time, and support smoother workflow management during high-intensity periods.

4. Interpretation of Results and Recommendations

The analysis indicates that Tulsi's operational challenges are primarily driven by unstructured inventory planning, increasing online competition, and uneven workload distribution during peak hours. Inventory findings show that Kurti Sets alone contribute approximately 50.3% of total inventory investment, while excess stock accumulation of nearly ₹1.52L during February 2026 highlights that procurement continued despite declining post-season demand. This resulted in unnecessary capital blockage and reduced inventory efficiency.

Competition analysis reveals that Tulsi primarily competes within the medium and upper-medium price segment against platforms such as Myntra and Ajio, where online discount campaigns create growing pricing pressure. The workload analysis further shows that customer activity remains concentrated during afternoon and evening hours, while morning periods are comparatively underutilized. Overall, the findings confirm the need for a structured, data-driven operational approach to improve inventory turnover, optimize staff utilization, and strengthen competitiveness.

4.1 Recommendations for Inventory Management

Tulsi should implement an EOQ and Reorder Point-based procurement system for Class inventory categories, particularly Kurti Sets. Procurement should begin once inventory reaches the ROP level of 62 units while maintaining a Safety Stock of 22 units.

The store should also replace intuition-based purchasing with demand-driven inventory review conducted on a monthly basis. This can reduce stagnant inventory, improve stock turnover, and prevent unnecessary capital blockage.

4.2 Recommendations for Competitive Positioning

Tulsi should adopt flexible seasonal pricing and bundle offers during periods of high online discount activity. Medium-range products should be strategically priced to remain competitive without significantly affecting profit margins.

To strengthen long-term competitiveness, the store should focus on customer experience advantages such as personalized assistance, immediate product availability, and trust-based interaction, where online platforms remain comparatively weaker.

4.3 Recommendations for Operational Efficiency

Staff allocation should be aligned with customer flow intensity. Customer-facing staff should be concentrated during peak periods between 3 PM and 7 PM in winter and 6 PM and 9 PM in summer. Backend activities such as inventory arrangement, stock verification, and tagging should be shifted to low-traffic morning periods to improve operational efficiency without increasing staffing costs. The store can further improve workflow management by gradually implementing a zonal sales support system during peak operational periods.

4.4 Expected Business Impact

Implementing these recommendations can improve inventory turnover, reduce excess stock accumulation, and strengthen cash flow management. Scientific inventory planning through EOQ and ROP can minimize capital blockage, while workload-based staff allocation can improve customer-handling efficiency during peak hours. In the long term, combining structured procurement planning with customer-focused competitive strategies can help Tulsi improve operational sustainability and profitability within the competitive ethnic wear retail market.